Blackwood If you have an agreed suit, you can find out how many Aces (and Kings) partner holds by using a 4NT bid. A reply of 5♣ shows 0 or 4, 5♦ shows 1, 5♥ shows 2 and 5♠ shows 3.

If your side has all four Aces, bidding 5NT will repeat the process for Kings.

The Replier can show one Ace plus a Void by bidding 6 of the Void suit if it ranks below the agreed trump, or 6 of the trump suit if the Void ranks above.
A Reply of 5NT shows two Aces plus a Void in some suit.

Gerber : Similar to Blackwood, this convention uses a 4♣ bid to initiate the Ace question, with 4♦ showing 0 or 4, 4♥ showing 1, 4♠ showing 2 and 4NT showing 3.

Not all 4♣ bids are Gerber, and deciding which ones are needs to be addressed by the partnership. For these Deals 4♣ is Gerber only when it follows a bid of 1NT or 2NT.

BakerBridge has complete lessons for these two conventions.

Board: 1
Dealer: **South**

Contract: 5♥
Declarer: North
Lead: ♦A

Board: 2
Dealer: **West**

Contract: 6NT
Declarer: East
Lead: ♥5

Board: 3
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 6♠
Declarer: South
Lead: ♦5

Board: 4
Dealer: **East**

Contract: 6♥
Declarer: West
Lead: ♦4

Board 1
South Deals
None Vul

	♠ J 7 3 ♥ A J 10 9 8 ♦ 8 3 2 ♣ Q 8	
♠ Q 10 6 5 ♥ 7 2 ♦ 10 9 5 ♣ A 9 7 2	N W E S	♠ 9 8 4 ♥ 4 3 ♦ A 7 6 4 ♣ 10 5 4 3
	♠ A K 2 ♥ K Q 6 5 ♦ K Q J ♣ K J 6	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			2♣
Pass	2♥	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♦[2]	Pass	5♥
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 1 ace

5♥ by North
Lead: ♦A

SOUTH is tempted to go right to 6♥ when she hears NORTH's positive response. BUT, she should use Blackwood first.

It's good thing she did because NORTH admits to only one Ace - they are missing two Aces.

Board 2
West Deals
N-S Vul

♠ J 8 7 5
♥ Q J 6
♦ 8 2
♣ A J 6 4

♠ K Q 4
♥ A 8
♦ K Q J 10 7 3
♣ K 5



♠ A 6 3
♥ K 10 7
♦ A 9 4
♣ Q 9 8 7

♠ 10 9 2
♥ 9 5 4 3 2
♦ 6 5
♣ 10 3 2

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
1♦	Pass	2NT	Pass
4♣	Pass	4♠	Pass
6NT			
All Pass			

6NT by East
Lead: ♥5

WEST not only has 20 points, he also has a lot of winners. So when EAST jumps to 2NT, showing 13-15 points, WEST uses Gerber.

EAST shows two Aces so WEST decides 6NT will be just right.

Board 3
North Deals
None Vul

	♠ K Q 8 5 ♥ J 6 3 ♦ 8 7 ♣ A Q J 4	
♠ 10 7 ♥ K Q 10 9 8 7 ♦ 5 ♣ 10 8 6 3		♠ 4 2 ♥ 5 2 ♦ K 10 9 4 3 2 ♣ 9 7 2
	♠ A J 9 6 3 ♥ A 4 ♦ A Q J 6 ♣ K 5	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♣	Pass	2♠
Pass	3♠	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♠[2]	Pass	5NT[3]
Pass	6♣[4]	Pass	6♠
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 3 aces
3. asks for kings
4. 0 kings

6♠ by South
Lead: ♦5

When NORTH gives immediate ♠ support, SOUTH's thoughts naturally turn to slam. This is a good hand to use Blackwood on, so SOUTH bids 4NT.

NORTH's 5♦ answer shows one Ace, which SOUTH cleverly deduces must be the ♣A.

SOUTH bids 6♠ since NORTH has not bid strongly enough to think about 7.

Board 4
East Deals
Both Vul

♠ 9 7 2
♥ 3 2
♦ 10 6 4
♣ A 10 9 4 2

♠ A 6 4
♥ Q J 9 8 7 4
♦ J 9 8 3
♣ —



♠ K Q J
♥ A K 10
♦ K Q 2
♣ K Q 7 3

♠ 10 8 5 3
♥ 6 5
♦ A 7 5
♣ J 8 6 5

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		2♣	Pass
2♥	Pass	3♥	Pass
3♠	Pass	4NT	Pass
6♣	Pass	6♥	
All Pass			

6♥ by West
Lead: ♦4

EAST expects to bid 2NT at his second turn, but WEST gives a positive 2♥ response and his thinking changes! First he supports ♥s, setting the trump suit.

WEST then bids 3♠, showing first round control. EAST tries 4NT (Blackwood) and WEST replies 6♣. This shows a ♣ void and one Ace, obviously the ♠A.

EAST bids 6♥, knowing they must lose the ♦A.